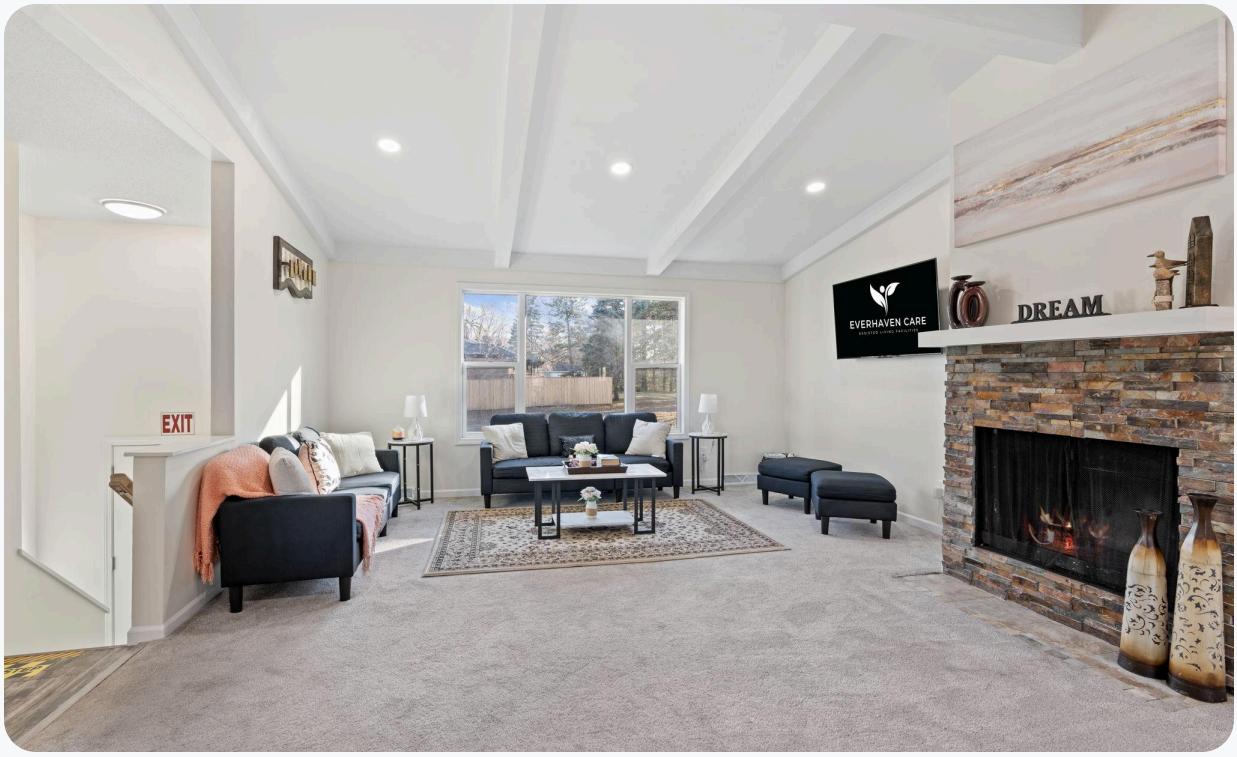
EVERHAVEN CARE
ASSISTED LIVING FACILITIES




FREE FAMILY GUIDE · 2026

# Paying for assisted living in Minnesota

CADI, Elderly Waiver, Housing Support and private pay, explained in plain English for families.

THE BIG PICTURE

# Assisted living has two bills. Pay for each one separately.

This is the part most families don't hear until they're already overwhelmed. Once you see the two buckets, every program in this guide makes sense.

BUCKET 1

## Care

Help with bathing, dressing, medications, transfers, supervision and nursing oversight. In Minnesota, waiver programs call this "customized living."

CADI waiver · Elderly Waiver · Private pay · LTC insurance

BUCKET 2

## Room and board

The rent and the meals. Waivers generally don't cover this part, so it comes from the resident's own income, Housing Support, or both.

Resident's income · Housing Support · Private pay · VA benefits

THE USUAL PATH

1

### Get assessed

Request a MnCHOICES assessment from your county. It decides which programs your loved one qualifies for.

2

### Line up funding

The care side through CADI, Elderly Waiver or private pay. Room and board through income, Housing Support or private pay.

3

### Choose the home

Pick a licensed assisted living that accepts that funding and can meet the care needs. Then tour it.

**Good to know:** Medical Assistance (MA) is the doorway to both waivers. If your loved one isn't on MA yet, the county can help you apply at the same time as the assessment.

STEP 1

# Start with a MnCHOICES assessment.

MnCHOICES is Minnesota's assessment for long-term services. A certified assessor meets with your loved one and decides which publicly funded programs they qualify for, including CADI and Elderly Waiver.

## How to request one

Call the county where your loved one lives. Anyone can start the call: the person, a family member, or a hospital or rehab social worker.

- **Ramsey County** (Shoreview, Roseville, St. Paul): **651-266-4500**
- **Anoka County** LTSS Intake: **763-324-1450**
- **Other counties:** call county human services and ask for a MnCHOICES assessment.

## Not sure where to start?

- Older adults and families: **Senior LinkAge Line 1-800-333-2433**
- Under 65 with a disability: **Disability Hub MN 1-866-333-2466**

## What to expect

- An in-person visit at home, in the hospital, or wherever your loved one is staying.
- It often takes about two hours. Family can and should be there.
- Questions about daily routines, health, memory, safety and goals.
- If eligible, a case manager is assigned to help set up services.

**Tip:** Be honest about the hard days, not just the good ones. The assessment is based on what help is actually needed.

? **Already in a hospital or transitional care unit?** Ask the discharge planner or social worker to send the MnCHOICES referral for you. It's often the fastest route.

STEP 2 · THE CARE BUCKET

# CADI or Elderly Waiver?

Both are Medical Assistance programs that can pay for care in assisted living. Which one fits depends mostly on age.

| | UNDER 65<br>CADI waiver | 65 AND OLDER<br>Elderly Waiver (EW) |
|---|---|---|
| **Full name** | Community Access for Disability Inclusion | Elderly Waiver |
| **Age** | Younger than 65 when first opening to the waiver | 65 or older |
| **Medical Assistance** | Must be eligible for MA | Must be eligible for MA long-term care, through regular MA or a plan like MSHO or MSC+ |
| **Disability** | Certified disabled by Social Security or the State Medical Review Team | No disability certification needed |
| **Level of care** | Needs nursing home level of care, per MnCHOICES | Needs nursing home level of care, per MnCHOICES |
| **Pays for** | Care services, including customized living in assisted living | Care services, including customized living in assisted living |
| **Doesn't pay for** | Room and board | Room and board |
| **Worth knowing** | Newer assisted living settings may only serve CADI residents age 55 and older, which is why many homes, including EverHaven, serve adults 55+. | Some people owe a monthly "waiver obligation" based on their income. The county figures this out. |

**Turning 65 on CADI?** Ask the case manager what happens to the waiver at 65 before the birthday, so there's no gap in services.

STEP 2 · THE ROOM AND BOARD BUCKET

# Housing Support, private pay and other help.

HOUSING SUPPORT · FORMERLY GRH

## Help with rent and meals

A state program that pays for room and board in approved settings, including licensed assisted living that serves three meals a day. It's often paired with CADI or Elderly Waiver, since waivers pay for care but not rent.

- **Who it's for:** adults who are aged, blind, or disabled, with low income and limited assets.
- **How it works:** the resident contributes most of their own income, and Housing Support covers the rest of the room and board rate.
- **How to apply:** ask your county financial worker or case manager.

## Private pay

Families can pay privately for care and room and board together. The monthly rate depends on the care plan, so homes usually quote after an assessment.

- Ask what's included and what's extra.
- Ask how the rate changes if care needs go up.
- If savings run low later, apply for Medical Assistance early so there's no gap.

## Other help to check

- **Long-term care insurance:** many policies cover assisted living. Call the insurer and ask how to start a claim.
- **VA Aid and Attendance:** a monthly payment added to a VA pension for veterans and surviving spouses who need help with daily activities. Call the VA at **1-800-827-1000** or a county veterans service officer.

**Mixing is normal.** A common setup is CADI or Elderly Waiver for the care bucket, plus the resident's income and Housing Support for the room and board bucket.

STEP 3

# Your checklists.

## Gather before you call the county

- [ ] Medical Assistance status and MA ID number, if any
- [ ] Social Security and Medicare cards
- [ ] Monthly income: Social Security, pensions, other
- [ ] Recent bank statements and a list of assets
- [ ] Current medication list
- [ ] Primary doctor's name and phone
- [ ] Power of attorney or guardianship papers
- [ ] Recent hospital or rehab discharge papers

## Ask every assisted living you tour

- [ ] Are you licensed by MDH? What's your license number?
- [ ] Which waivers and Housing Support do you accept?
- [ ] What care levels can you handle? Two-person transfers? Behavioral needs?
- [ ] How many residents live here, and how many staff are on each shift?
- [ ] Is there an RN involved in care plans?
- [ ] How are medications handled?
- [ ] What happens if care needs increase?
- [ ] What's included in the monthly rate, and what costs extra?

EVERHAVEN CARE
ASSISTED LIVING FACILITIES

## Questions? We'll walk you through it.

EverHaven Care is a licensed five-bed assisted living home in Shoreview for adults 55+. We accept CADI, Elderly Waiver, Housing Support and private pay, and we assess within 24 hours.

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General information only, not legal or financial advice. Current as of October 2026. Program rules, income and asset limits, and rates change, and your county, tribal nation or health plan makes the final eligibility decision. Sources: Minnesota Department of Human Services program pages for CADI, Elderly Waiver and Housing Support; Ramsey and Anoka County MnCHOICES intake pages; Minnesota House Research (2024); U.S. Department of Veterans Affairs.